

ESMATULLAH AKBARI

es.akbari.ak@gmail.com | +93 792 013 520 | Herat, Afghanistan

Languages: English (Fluent) | Dari/Farsi (Native) | Pashto (Fluent)

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Results-driven English lecturer, academic leader, and development professional with over 5 years of progressive experience in higher education, monitoring and evaluation, field research, and NGO communication. Demonstrated expertise in curriculum development, multi-stakeholder coordination, data collection (Kobo/ODK), and community engagement across Afghanistan and internationally. Proven track record of leading academic departments, delivering university-level English language instruction, and managing capacity-building programs in high-stakes, multicultural environments. Committed to education quality, inclusion, and measurable social impact.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- English Language Teaching & Training
- Curriculum & Lesson Plan Development
- Academic Department Leadership
- Faculty Supervision & Mentoring
- Communication & Stakeholder Coordination
- Student Assessment & Academic Support
- Monitoring & Evaluation (M&E)
- Qualitative & Quantitative Research
- Data Collection & Analysis (Kobo/ODK)
- Community Mobilization & Engagement
- Report Writing & Documentation
- NGO Program Management

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Head of Department & English Lecturer

June 2024 – June 2026

Woman Online University (WOU) | Herat, Afghanistan

- Led academic planning, departmental strategy, and operational management for the English department
- Supervised faculty recruitment, onboarding, professional development, and performance evaluation
- Delivered university-level English language lectures aligned with institutional learning outcomes
- Maintained academic quality assurance systems, student support structures, and institutional reporting
- Coordinated curriculum review processes and contributed to institutional accreditation activities

Field Monitor

Aug 2024 – Feb 2025

Integrity Watch Afghanistan (IWA) | Afghanistan

- Conducted systematic field monitoring visits and project site assessments across multiple provinces
- Collected qualitative and quantitative data using Kobo/ODK digital tools with high accuracy and compliance
- Coordinated with local authorities, community leaders, and stakeholders to facilitate field access
- Transcribed, translated (Dari/English), and analyzed field data for internal and donor reporting
- Ensured data confidentiality and adherence to organizational monitoring standards

Lecturer – Faculty of Education

Jan 2024 – Jul 2024

Herat University | Herat, Afghanistan

- Delivered structured English language lectures to undergraduate students in the Faculty of Education
- Designed comprehensive lesson plans, assessments, and academic resource materials
- Provided student mentoring, constructive feedback, and academic guidance throughout the semester
- Participated in curriculum development, departmental committees, and faculty activities
- Maintained accurate student performance records and academic documentation

Communication Officer

Jan 2023 – Dec 2023

Development Organization for Needy (DSON) | Afghanistan

- Developed and implemented organizational communication and outreach strategies
- Managed content production for social media channels, donor reports, and institutional platforms
- Coordinated stakeholder engagement, media communication, and public visibility campaigns
- Collected and analyzed programmatic data to support reporting and strategic decision-making
- Supported organizational branding and public engagement initiatives

Community Mobilizer

Jan 2022 – Dec 2022

ASEWO | Afghanistan

- Mobilized community members for participation in development programs and awareness campaigns
- Facilitated community meetings, awareness sessions, and focus group discussions
- Coordinated with local leaders, stakeholders, and government officials for program implementation
- Collected field data using Kobo/ODK systems; maintained data integrity and confidentiality
- Promoted women's inclusion and participation across all project activities

Research Officer

Jun 2021 – Dec 2021

ASLO | Afghanistan

- Designed and conducted qualitative research including Focus Group Discussions (FGDs) and interviews
- Collected, transcribed, and translated field data from Dari to English for research documentation
- Coordinated access to communities and facilitated engagement with local authorities
- Assisted in data analysis, findings synthesis, and preparation of research reports

EDUCATION

Master of Arts in Teaching English as a Foreign Language (TEFL)

2025 – 2026

Persian Gulf University | Iran

Bachelor of Arts in English Language & Literature

2019 – 2023

Herat University | Herat, Afghanistan

Thesis: Investigating EFL Students' Speaking Fluency (2023)

RESEARCH PUBLICATIONS

- Akbari, E. (2023). Investigating EFL Students' Speaking Fluency. Herat University.
- Akbari, E. (2025). Resilience in Education: Coping Strategies of Afghan Students in Times of Crisis.
- Akbari, E. (2026). Writing Anxiety among Afghan Female EFL Learners in Online Education.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Data Collection Tools:

Kobo Toolbox, ODK

Statistical & GIS Software:	SPSS, ArcGIS, Ant-Conc, TagAnt, Zotero, Mendeley
Microsoft Office Suite:	Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Outlook
Web Technologies:	Full-Stack Developer
Languages:	English (Fluent), Dari/Farsi (Native), Pashto (Fluent)

CERTIFICATIONS & PROFESSIONAL TRAINING

- Human Rights Monitoring – United States Institute of Peace (USIP)
- Empowering Youth Leaders – UN Women (ECOSOC)
- ICT & ICDL Certification – USAID Afghanistan Women's Development Program (AWDP)
- Research Methodology Training – Integrity Watch Afghanistan (IWA)
- Data Collection Methodology – DACAAR
- Project Team Management & Communication – ASEWO
- Integrity Volunteers Boot Camp – IWA
- Psychosocial Support Training – Persian Gulf University (PGU)
- Professional Teaching & Training – OSAA
- English Communication Skills – World English Institute (USA)
- Management Skills – Herat University
- Technical Secretary Certification – OPA, Woman Online University

REFERENCES

Kamal Joyanda	Farid Salangy
Program Manager, Integrity Watch Afghanistan (IWA)	Chancellor, Woman Online University (WOU)
k.joinda@integritywatch.org +93 771 170 203	info@womanonlineuniversity.com +32 466 356 545

Sayed Nasir Gharjistani
Senior Officer, Development Organization for Needy (DSON)
snasir.gha1@gmail.com | +93 748 864 968